UNIT 7

Sustainable Development



Unit Overview

7.1 Introduction

7.2 Concept and Goals of Sustainable development

7.3 Climate Change and Sustainability

7.4 Watershed management and its importance

7.5 Environmental Impact Assessment

7.6 Measures for promotion of sustainable development

Learning Objectives

- *To describe the importance of Sustainable Development.*
- *To highlight the interconnectivity between man, environment and economic growth.*
- *To understand the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals.*
- *To underline individual's role in creating a sustainable earth.*

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7.1. Introduction

In the last few centuries there has been a drastic change in the lifestyle of man. Agricultural growth, industrialization, urbanization, rapid advancement in science and technology have decreased mortality rates and caused rapid growth of population over the earth. With increase in population there is an increase in the demand for natural resources leading to overuse, of nature and its resources. Nations began to wake up to the fact that the earth's resources are depleting at an alarming rate and that something has to be done to sustain them. This led to develop the world in a sustainable way. Sustainability is supported by four pillars which are cultural vitality, economic health, environmental responsibility and social equity. All nations in the world focus on sustainable development as a major task.

United Nations and Sustainable Development

Sustainability was first featured in the principles adopted by the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment held at Stockholm on 16 June 1972. It was now realized that development needed to be sustainable – it should not only focus on economic and social matters, but also on matters related to the use of natural resources. The United Nations commissioned a group of 22 people from both developed and developing countries to identify long-term environmental strategies for the international community. This World Commission on Environment and Development (WCED), was headed by Gro Harlem Brundtland, then the Prime Minister of Norway. This commission came

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